possible, for the greater part of Khusrau Shāh's force has broken up and is ready to take service with him.'

Bad news arrived just when Moghūls were submitting themselves to Babur's service. After taking Andijān, Shaybāni Khān was heading to conquer Ḥiṣār and Qūndūz once again. Upon hearing this, the perturbed Khusrau Shāh marched out of Qūndūz and took the road for Kābul with all the men he had. Interestingly, no sooner had he left than his old able and trusted servant Mullā Muḥammad Turkistānī made Qūndūz fast for Shaybāni Khān. The terror of Shaybāni Khān was known to all and hence it was certainly important to secure the place beforehand.

Around 4000 heads of houses in the Moghūl horde, earlier dependents of Khusrau Shāh, brought their families and joined Babur while he and his men were going through Sham-tū near the Qīzīl-sū.

Qaṃbar-'alī Dismissed

Babur has been observing Qaṃbar-'alī's behaviour for a while. The latter had often critiqued and even humiliated the former. Babur has mentioned Qaṃbar-'alī talking foolish things quite often. Qaṃbar had begun to disrespect and displease Bāqī Beg, which Babur found to be unpardonable. Babur dismissed him without thinking twice. Perhaps it was more to gratify Bāqī Beg. Thereafter his son, 'Abdu'l-shukūr, was put in Jahāngīr Mīrzā's service.

On the other hand, Khusrau Shāh was quite dismayed to know that his Moghūl horde had joined Babur. Seeing no better way out, he sent his son-in-law, Ayūb Yaq'ūb to Babur, intending to crack a deal in return for his services. Babur didn't deny his offer after the node of Bāqī Chaghānīānī. Babur considered Bāqī Chaghānīānī an important man, and despite being loyal to him, he did not overlook his brother's side this time. A deal was made that Khusrau Shāh would be given whatever amount of goods he asked for and he would always be safe in Babur's hands. After the deal with Yaq'ūb, they marched down the Qīzīl-sū and didn't dismount till they touched the water of Andar-āb.

August of AD 1504 was about to end. The time of Babur's nomadic life was passing by quickly.

They rested at the bank of Andar-āb. The next day, they crossed the Andar-āb water and arrived close to Dūshī. There, Babur took a seat under a large plane tree, where Khusrau Shāh met him. He displayed acute splendour, and he had brought a great company of men. He followed the tradition and protocol of dismounting at a certain distance from Babur and made his way to him. He knelt three times on arrival and repeated the gesture when seeking leave. He